

# Poisoning - Female (Child)

Algorithm 1118 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Female

## Definition

- UAT-only fail-closed assessment of suspected poisoning or overdose by ingestion, inhalation, eye or skin contact, injection, or bite/sting in adults and children.
- Child patient.
- Female.

## Initial assessment

1. [OPEN\_TEXT] What is the person's age, approximate weight, relevant medical history, pregnancy status, current symptoms, and exact location?
2. [OPEN\_TEXT] What substance or product was involved? Read the exact label, ingredients, strength, container size, warning symbols, and manufacturer when available; do not guess from color or appearance.
3. [OPEN\_TEXT] Was it swallowed, inhaled, injected, splashed in the eye, placed on the skin, or delivered by a bite or sting, and what is the maximum possible amount or duration of exposure?
4. [DURATION] When did the exposure occur, and has any first aid, food, drink, medicine, or attempted vomiting already occurred?
5. [YES\_NO] Is the person collapsed, difficult to wake, confused, having a seizure, choking, drooling or unable to swallow, struggling to breathe, blue or grey, severely agitated, or showing a serious burn?
6. [YES\_NO] Was the exposure deliberate, related to self-harm, or associated with an unsafe environment or possible neglect? For a child, are other children at risk from the same unsecured substance?
7. [YES\_NO] Is the original container, medicine packet, safety data sheet, or a clear photograph available to show the poison specialist without delaying care?
8. [CAREGIVER\_OBSERVATION] What change has a safe parent or caregiver observed in behaviour, alertness, eating or drinking, sleep, school or play, and normal activity?

## Triage and redirect questions

### **1. Redirect → Carbon Monoxide Exposure**

Is suspected carbon monoxide exposure from a heater, fire, generator, engine, or enclosed-space source the main concern?

Carbon monoxide has a dedicated exposure and evacuation pathway.

### **1. Disposition level 100**

After a suspected exposure, is the person collapsed, unresponsive or difficult to wake, having a seizure, choking, unable to swallow, severely confused or agitated, blue or grey, not breathing normally, having severe breathing difficulty, showing a serious chemical burn, or at immediate risk after a deliberate overdose or self-harm exposure?

Life-threatening poisoning features require Qatar 999. Sidra's Qatar Poison Center explicitly states that it cannot dispatch ambulances and that life-threatening situations must call 999. Deliberate overdose also requires immediate safety and medical assessment.

### **1. Disposition level 70**

With no emergency feature above, is any potentially harmful or unknown exposure suspected, including a medicine error or overdose, household or workplace chemical, gas or fume, eye or skin splash, injection, or bite or sting?

The Qatar Poison Center provides individualized advice for adults and children based on age, weight, medical history, substance, amount, route, symptoms, and timing. An asymptomatic exposure cannot be declared safe from generic protocol logic; poison-specialist assessment is required.

## Advice

### **Qatar poisoning emergency response**

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999, use emergency ambulance transport, do not allow self-driving, and follow the call handler's instructions. Protect yourself from contamination and move away from fumes only if safe. Do not induce vomiting or give food, drink, charcoal, antidotes, or oral medicine unless 999 or the Qatar Poison Center specifically directs it. If unresponsive and not breathing normally, begin CPR if trained and safe from contamination; if unconscious but breathing, use the recovery position unless injury prevents it. Keep the original container or clear product photograph for responders without delaying care. For deliberate exposure, maintain safe supervision and remove access to remaining substances only when safe. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: reduced responsiveness; seizure; abnormal breathing; choking or inability to swallow; blue or grey color; serious burn; deliberate overdose or self-harm.

### **Qatar Poison Center assessment and route-specific first aid**

- Call Sidra Medicine's Qatar Poison Center on +974 4003 1111 during its published hours (09:00-01:00 daily) for individualized adult or child advice; it is a phone service and cannot dispatch an ambulance. Do not wait for symptoms and do not induce vomiting or give anything by mouth unless directed. For inhalation, move to fresh air without entering an unsafe area. For eye exposure, remove contact lenses when easy and rinse immediately with plenty of room-temperature water for 15-20 minutes. For skin exposure, remove contaminated clothing while avoiding secondary exposure and rinse with plenty of room-temperature running water for at least 15 minutes; brush off a dry chemical first only when its label or a poison specialist directs this. Keep the product/container available. Outside published hours, the approved Qatar non-emergency toxicology route requires local approval; call 999 for any deterioration or uncertainty about immediate safety.
- Call Back If: any new symptom; drowsiness or confusion; vomiting or drooling; breathing difficulty; seizure; persistent eye pain or vision change; worsening skin pain or burn.

## First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999, use emergency ambulance transport, do not allow self-driving, and follow the call handler's instructions. Protect yourself from contamination and move away from fumes only if safe. Do not induce vomiting or give food, drink, charcoal, antidotes, or oral medicine unless 999 or the Qatar Poison Center specifically directs it. If unresponsive and not breathing normally, begin CPR if trained and safe

from contamination; if unconscious but breathing, use the recovery position unless injury prevents it. Keep the original container or clear product photograph for responders without delaying care. For deliberate exposure, maintain safe supervision and remove access to remaining substances only when safe. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

## References

- Sidra Medicine, "Qatar Poison Center", <https://www.sidra.org/clinic/children-young-peoples-services/qatar-poison-center/> (accessed 2026-07-25)
- Qatar Ministry of Public Health, "Healthcare Services in Qatar", <https://sportandhealth.moph.gov.qa/EN/faninfo/Pages/HealthcareServicesInQatar.aspx> (accessed 2026-07-25)
- NHS.UK, "Poisoning", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/poisoning/> (page last reviewed 12 June 2025)
- US CDC/NIOSH, "First Aid Procedures for Chemical Hazards", <https://www.cdc.gov/niosh/npg/firstaid.html>
- National Capital Poison Center, "First aid guidelines", <https://www.poison.org/first-aid-for-poisonings>

## Provenance

Shaped to mirror the licensed After-Hours Telehealth Triage Guidelines database structure. This is IST open-source guideline content derived from the cited NHS.UK pages under the Open Government Licence v3.0; it is not licensed STCC content. Question.DispositionLevel=null marks a See More Appropriate Guideline redirect and is not a disposition row. Local extensions, destination mappings, safeguarding workflows, and TelemedicineEligible values require IST clinical governance approval. UAT DATA ONLY - NOT FOR REAL-PATIENT CARE OR PRODUCTION USE.

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